CHRISTIAN KONTZ

Stanford University ◇ Graduate School of Business
Knight Center, 655 Knight Way, Stanford, CA 94305
christiankontz.com ◇ ckontz@stanford.edu

EDUCATION

Stanford Graduate School of Business *2020–present*
Ph.D. Candidate in Finance
Dissertation Committee: Juliane Begenau, Hanno Lustig (co-chair), Monika Piazzesi, Amit Seru (co-chair)

Barcelona Graduate School of Economics, Universitat Pompeu Fabra *2018*
Master in International Trade, Finance, and Development

University of Hamburg *2017*
B.Sc. in Economics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Climate Finance, Empirical Asset Pricing

WORKING PAPERS

1. *The Real Cost of Benchmarking* with Sebastian Hanson [SSRN]
2. *Do ESG Investors Care About Carbon Emissions? Evidence From Securitized Auto Loans* [SSRN]

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. *Explaining Prices* with Hanno Lustig
2. *From Markets to Meters: How Passive Investing Affects Utility Rates*
3. *ESG Induced Capital Misallocation: is ESG Doing Good, by Doing Well?*

PRESENTATIONS

SFS Cavalcade NA Conference*, FIRS Conference*, Four Corners Center Academic Meeting* *2025*
Northeastern University Finance Conference*, UIC Finance Conference*,^{c}
AFA Annual Meeting (2x Poster), Inter-Finance PhD Seminar*

FIRS Conference, SoFiE Conference, SITE New Research in Asset Pricing†, GRASFI Conference *2024*
OU-RFS Climate and Energy Conference, CEPR-ESSEC-Luxembourg Conference on Sustainable
Financial Intermediation, FMA Conference, MFR Summer Session for Young Scholars (Poster),
UC Santa Cruz CAFIN, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (CESifo),
Citadel^{c}, Inter-Finance PhD Seminar

Harvard Climate Economics Workshop, USC Marshall PhD Conference, MFR/IMSI Conference (Poster) *2023*
UChicago Workshop on Climate, Uncertainty and Policy, NYU Shanghai/SoFiE Summer School

German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (DIW) *2022*

*scheduled, ^{c}co-author, †declined/scheduling conflict

OTHER RESEARCH POSITIONS

The Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE Frankfurt *April 2025*
Visiting Researcher

University of Chicago *Spring 2023*
Visiting Student, invited by Fernando Alvarez, Lars Hansen, and Esteban Rossi-Hansberg

US Census Bureau *2022-present*
Special Sworn Status (SSS)

Princeton University *2018–2020*
Research Assistant to Natalie Cox, Moritz Lenel, and Adrien Matray

University of Hamburg *2016–2017*
Research Assistant to Christiane Hellmanzik and Mu-Chun Wang

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stanford Graduate School of Business

Capital Markets and Institutional Investing, TA to Hanno Lustig and Ana Marshall	*2023, 2024*
Corporations, Finance, and Governance in the Global Economy, TA to Amit Seru	*2022, 2023, 2024, 2025*
Debt Markets, TA to Darrell Duffie	*2021, 2022*
Modeling for Investment Management, TA to Steven Grenadier	*2023, 2024, 2025*

University of Hamburg

Macroeconomics 1 (UG), TA to Kristin Paetz	*2016*

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Lecture Series Organization: Stanford Lecture Series on the History of Economic Thought (2020/21)
Seminar Series Organization: Inter-Finance PhD Seminar (2024/25), GSB Finance Brown Bag (2022/23)
Referee: Management Science

SCHOLARSHIPS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

Nominated by Stanford GSB finance faculty for the Gerald J. Lieberman Fellowship	*2025*
FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students ($1,000)	*2024*
Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize ($12,500)	*2024*
GRASFI Conference Best PhD Paper Award (£750)	*2024*
Graduate Fellowship, Stanford Graduate School of Business	*2020–present*
Pre-doctoral Fellowship, Julis-Rabinowitz Center at Princeton University	*2018–2020*
Graduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom	*2017–2018*
Undergraduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom	*2015–2017*

BUSINESS EXPERIENCE

Co-founder and CFO, vierfreunde GmbH (*Kerbholz - wooden fashion accessories*)	*2011–2014*
Apprenticeship as Industriekaufmann (industrial business management assistant)	*2009–2011*